

6.1 The Mac OS X Desktop

When Mac OS X is started for the first time, you'll see something similar to the image below on the screen.

The Main Mac OS X Screen Elements

- The menu bar for the active application appears at the top of the screen.
- The Dock appears at the bottom of the screen.
- Windows appear anywhere on the screen. The picture on the right shows a Finder window.

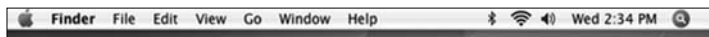


The Mac OS X Desktop

- The Desktop appears behind all windows.

The following sections provide more information about each of these elements. You will discover these and similar elements in all the Mac OS X applications you use.

6.1.1 The Menu Bar



The Menu Bar is the Apple's equivalent of the Windows Task bar

The menu bar provides commands that are used to perform tasks.

Here's a quick run-down of the menu bar from left to right:

- The Apple menu at the left is always available. It provides commands for changing many computer-wide settings, updating Apple software, and shutting down the computer.
- Next are the menus for the active application, starting with the application menu, which shows the name of the application in bold. Applications have many of the same menus, such